

9.3.3 Navigating Your Mind Map

Creating big, complex mind maps is all very well, but you'll soon be cursing the Creator if you don't know how to work your way through the map to get the information you need. The most basic things you need to know are panning and zooming - just click and



Set reminders for tasks right within FreeMind

drag in an empty area of the map to pan it. To zoom, hold down [Ctrl] and use your mouse's scroll wheel. It works in the opposite way you'd expect it to - [Ctrl] + [Scroll Up] zooms out instead of in, and vice versa. Weird, but you get used to it.

If you're viewing a huge mind map, the first thing you need to do is collapse all the trees and leave only the first level of nodes visible. This will help you navigate the map in a much less chaotic fashion. To do this, select the central node and click on the grey "-" icon on the toolbar (or use the [Alt] + [Home] shortcut). Like we mentioned before, you can use the arrow keys to navigate the nodes; to expand and collapse node trees, use [Space]. To get to the central node from anywhere, hit [Esc].

9.3.4 Setting Reminders In Nodes

If you want to be reminded of any task or item inside your mind map, you can have FreeMind set up a reminder for you. Select the node you want to be reminded about, go to Tools > Show Calendar, select a date and choose Remind Me At This Date. A clock icon will appear in the node, indicating that the reminder has been set.